

SmartPlate AI

THE GLOBAL CUISINE COOKBOOK

Real Recipes · Healthy Choices · A World of Flavors

51+ INTERNATIONAL RECIPES

From Africa to Asia · Europe to the Americas · All in One Book

Welcome

This cookbook collects recipes from every region SmartPlate AI covers — Africa, Asia, Europe, the Americas, the Middle East, and Oceania — alongside the everyday kitchen knowledge that makes a recipe actually work: how the main cooking methods differ, how to keep food good for longer, and how to put a plate together so it looks like it does in the photo.

Use it however suits you: read it front to back, jump straight to a region you're curious about, or keep it open next to your stove as a reference for cooking terms you run into elsewhere.

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Cooking Methods, Explained

Grilling

Cooking directly over high, dry heat. Best for cuts that are already tender and won't take long — kebabs, steaks, flatbreads. The high heat sears the outside quickly, so pat food dry first and don't crowd the grill, or you'll steam instead of sear.

Roasting

Cooking uncovered in an oven, using dry heat that circulates around the food. Suits larger cuts and whole vegetables. A hot oven at the start gives good color; many recipes then lower the heat so the inside cooks through without the outside burning.

Braising and stewing

Searing food first, then cooking it slowly, mostly submerged in liquid, in a covered pot. This is how tougher, well-worked cuts (shoulder, shank, oxtail) turn tender: the collagen breaks down over time into gelatin, which is what gives braises their silky sauce.

Stir-frying

Very fast cooking over very high heat, with constant movement. Everything needs to be cut small and prepped before you start, since there's no time to chop once the pan is hot. Cook in batches if you're making a lot — an overloaded pan drops in temperature and steams the food instead.

Steaming

Cooking with the vapor from boiling water, without submerging the food in it. Gentler than boiling, so it suits delicate things like fish, dumplings, and vegetables where you want to keep texture and nutrients rather than leach them into cooking water.

Simmering

Cooking in liquid just below a boil, with small, lazy bubbles rather than a rolling boil. Most soups, stocks, and sauces want a simmer, not a boil — a hard boil can make proteins tough and break emulsified sauces.

Deep and shallow frying

Cooking in hot oil, either fully submerged (deep-frying) or in a shallow pool (pan-frying). Oil temperature matters more than time: too cool and food absorbs oil and turns greasy; too hot and the outside burns before the inside cooks.

Sautéing

Cooking quickly in a small amount of fat over fairly high heat, tossing or stirring occasionally rather than constantly. A good middle ground between stir-frying's speed and braising's patience — most “soften the onions” steps in this book are a sauté.

Food Preservation at Home

Preserving food is really about controlling the conditions bacteria, mould, and enzymes need to spoil it — moisture, warmth, oxygen, and time. Each method below removes or limits one of those.

Freezing

Slows enzyme activity and stops microbial growth almost entirely, without changing flavor much. Freeze food quickly and in flat, well-sealed portions to limit ice crystals, which are what cause 'freezer texture' on thawing. Most cooked dishes in this book freeze well for one to three months.

Drying and dehydrating

Removes the moisture microbes need to grow. Works well for fruit, herbs, and thinly sliced meat (jerky). Food should be dry enough that it doesn't feel damp anywhere, then stored airtight, away from light, or it will reabsorb moisture.

Pickling

Uses acid (usually vinegar) to create an environment most spoilage bacteria can't survive in. Quick pickles kept in the fridge are the easiest and safest way to try this at home — they don't need any special equipment, just an acidic brine strong enough to keep the vegetables crisp and safe for a few weeks.

Fermenting

Relies on encouraging beneficial bacteria or yeast (as in sauerkraut, kimchi, or yogurt) to outcompete the organisms that spoil food, often by producing acid themselves. Keep vegetables fully submerged under their brine while fermenting, since anything exposed to air is prone to mould.

Canning and bottling

Uses heat to destroy microorganisms, then seals food in an airtight jar so nothing new gets in. This is the one method where getting it wrong has serious consequences — low-acid foods (most vegetables, meat, and stock) require pressure canning at a specific time and pressure to be safe, not just a boiling water bath. Don't improvise processing times: use a current, tested recipe from a source such as your national or local agricultural extension service, and adjust for your altitude as instructed.

Curing and smoking

Curing draws moisture out with salt (and often sugar and nitrates), while smoking adds both flavor and a mild preservative effect from the smoke itself. Traditional cured and smoked meats are a deep subject with real food-safety considerations around salt ratios and temperature; if you're new to it, start from a tested recipe rather than working from ratios you've guessed at.

A general rule across all of these: when in doubt, throw it out. No method of preservation makes food safe to eat if it smells off, looks discolored, or the container is bulging or leaking.

Serving and Plating

Warm the plate, not just the food

A hot dish loses heat fast on a cold plate. Warming plates in a low oven or under hot tap water (then drying them) keeps food at the right temperature for longer.

Sauce goes under or around, not over

Spooning sauce onto the plate first, then setting the protein or starch on top or beside it, keeps textures — a crisp skin, a crusted sear — from going soggy before it reaches the table.

Height and odd numbers

Stacking or leaning components, rather than laying everything flat, makes a plate look more considered. Grouping garnishes in ones or threes tends to look more natural than in twos or fours.

Garnish should be edible and relevant

A herb sprig or a scattering of the dish's own ingredients (the citrus it was cooked with, the nuts in a garnish) does more work than a decoration with no connection to what's on the plate.

Wipe the rim

The simplest, highest-impact step: a clean plate edge, free of drips and fingerprints, instantly reads as more polished, no matter how the food itself is arranged.

Nutrition Basics and Substitutions

None of this replaces advice from a doctor or dietitian, especially if you're managing a specific health condition — but a few general swaps come up often enough across these recipes to be worth keeping in mind.

Lowering sodium

Salt often does double duty as both seasoning and preservative in a recipe. Cutting it back usually needs another source of flavor to compensate — acid (lemon, vinegar), fresh herbs, or aromatics like garlic and ginger, rather than salt substitutes alone.

Reducing saturated fat

Swapping butter or cream for olive oil or a lower-fat dairy alternative works in most sautéed or braised dishes; it changes the flavor slightly but rarely the technique.

Lower-carb swaps

Cauliflower rice, shirataki or zucchini noodles, and lettuce wraps in place of rice, wheat noodles, or bread carry the same sauces and toppings in this book's recipes without the starch.

Gluten-free swaps

Rice, corn, and most legumes are naturally gluten-free; the main things to watch for are wheat-based thickeners (a roux), breadcrumbs, and flatbreads, which usually have a gluten-free alternative you can swap in directly.

Vegetarian and vegan swaps

Firm tofu, tempeh, and mushrooms (especially oyster or king oyster mushrooms) hold up well in dishes built around braising or grilling a piece of meat, since they take on marinades and sauces in a similar way.

African Recipes

Jollof Rice & Chicken · Nigeria

Smoky, hearty, festive | 60 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Long-grain rice 500g
- Tomatoes 6
- Red bell peppers 3
- Scotch bonnet pepper 1
- Chicken thighs 8
- Onion 2
- Thyme 1 tsp

Method

1. Blend the tomatoes, peppers and one onion into a smooth base.
2. Season and fry the chicken until browned, then set aside.
3. Fry the remaining onion in the chicken fat, add the blended base and cook down until thick.
4. Stir in the rice, thyme and stock, cover and simmer until the rice is tender.
5. Nestle the chicken back in to finish, then rest for 10 minutes before serving.

Egusi Soup · Nigeria

Nutty, rich, filling | 70 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Ground melon seeds 2 cups
- Palm oil 1/2 cup
- Spinach 2 bunches
- Beef 500g
- Stockfish 1 piece
- Onion 1
- Crayfish 2 tbsp

Method

1. Simmer the beef and stockfish in seasoned water until tender.
2. Heat the palm oil and fry the onion until soft.
3. Stir in the ground melon seeds in spoonfuls, forming small lumps as they fry.
4. Add the meat stock and crayfish, and simmer until thickened.
5. Fold in the spinach and cook for a final five minutes.

Doro Wat · Ethiopia

Spiced, slow-cooked chicken stew | 2 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken pieces 1.2kg
- Red onions 4
- Berbere spice 3 tbsp
- Niter kibbeh (spiced butter) 4 tbsp

- Garlic 4 cloves
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Hard-boiled eggs 6

Method

1. Cook the onions slowly with no oil until deeply softened.
2. Add the niter kibbeh, garlic, ginger and berbere, and fry until fragrant.
3. Add the chicken and a little water, and simmer until the sauce clings to the meat.
4. Add the boiled eggs and simmer another 10 minutes.
5. Serve with injera.

Chicken Tagine with Apricots · Morocco

Sweet, savory, aromatic | 80 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 8
- Dried apricots 1 cup
- Onion 2
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Cinnamon 1 stick
- Saffron pinch
- Almonds 1/2 cup toasted

Method

1. Brown the chicken in the tagine or a heavy pot.
2. Add the onion, ginger, cinnamon and saffron, and cook until fragrant.
3. Add water to half-cover, cover and simmer gently for an hour.
4. Stir in the apricots for the last 20 minutes.
5. Scatter with toasted almonds before serving.

Bunny Chow · South Africa

Curry-filled bread, hearty | 55 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Bread loaf, quartered
- Lamb or bean curry base
- Potatoes 2
- Curry powder 3 tbsp
- Onion 1
- Garlic 3 cloves
- Tomatoes 2

Method

1. Fry the onion and garlic, then add curry powder and toast briefly.
2. Add the meat or beans, tomatoes and potatoes with enough water to cover.
3. Simmer until thick and the potatoes are tender.
4. Hollow out the bread quarters, keeping the removed bread as a lid.
5. Fill each bread quarter with curry and serve hot.

Peri-Peri Chicken · Mozambique

Fiery, charred, citrusy | 50 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Chicken, spatchcocked
- Bird's eye chilies 6
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Lemon 2
- Paprika 1 tbsp
- Olive oil 1/3 cup

Method

1. Blend the chilies, garlic, lemon juice, paprika and oil into a marinade.
2. Coat the chicken and marinate at least an hour.
3. Grill or roast, basting with the marinade, until cooked through and charred.
4. Rest for 5 minutes before carving.

Koshari · Egypt

Layered carbs, tangy tomato sauce | 50 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Rice 1.5 cups
- Brown lentils 1 cup
- Small macaroni 1 cup
- Crispy fried onions 1 cup
- Tomato sauce 2 cups
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Cumin 1 tsp
- White vinegar

Method

1. Cook the rice, lentils and macaroni separately until tender.
2. Simmer the tomato sauce with garlic, cumin and a splash of vinegar until rich.
3. Layer rice, lentils and macaroni in a bowl.
4. Spoon the tomato sauce generously over the top.
5. Finish with a heavy scattering of crispy fried onions.

Tunisian Couscous with Lamb · Tunisia

Spiced, hearty, one-pot | 90 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Couscous 2 cups
- Lamb shoulder 600g
- Carrots 3
- Chickpeas 1 cup
- Harissa 2 tbsp
- Tomato paste 2 tbsp
- Onion 1

Method

1. Brown the lamb with onion, then stir in tomato paste and harissa.

2. Add water to cover, the carrots and chickpeas, and simmer until the lamb is tender.
3. Steam the couscous, fluffing with a fork and a little oil between steamings.
4. Mound the couscous on a platter.
5. Top with the lamb, vegetables and a ladle of the spiced broth.

Sadza with Beef Stew · Zimbabwe

Cornmeal staple, rich stew | 60 min | Easy

Ingredients

- White cornmeal 2 cups
- Water 4 cups
- Beef chuck 500g
- Onion 1
- Tomatoes 2
- Garlic 2 cloves
- Leafy greens 1 bunch

Method

1. Brown the beef with onion and garlic, then simmer with tomatoes until tender.
2. Bring water to a boil, whisk in a little cornmeal to form a loose porridge.
3. Gradually beat in the remaining cornmeal until it pulls into a stiff, smooth dough.
4. Wilt the greens briefly and season.
5. Serve the sadza alongside the stew and greens.

Groundnut Soup · Sierra Leone

Peanut stew, rich, warming | 55 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Peanut butter 1 cup
- Chicken thighs 600g
- Tomatoes 3
- Onion 1
- Scotch bonnet pepper 1
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Stock 3 cups

Method

1. Brown the chicken, then set aside.
2. Blend the tomatoes, onion, pepper and ginger into a smooth base.
3. Fry the base until thick, then stir in the peanut butter and stock.
4. Return the chicken and simmer until cooked through and the sauce is thick.
5. Serve hot over rice.

Asian Recipes

Sushi · Japan

Fresh and healthy | 45 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Sushi rice 2 cups
- Rice vinegar 4 tbsp
- Nori sheets 5
- Sushi-grade salmon 200g
- Cucumber 1
- Soy sauce
- Wasabi

Method

1. Cook the rice, then fold through the seasoned vinegar and cool to room temperature.
2. Lay a nori sheet on a mat and spread a thin layer of rice, leaving a border.
3. Add salmon and cucumber in a line, then roll tightly using the mat.
4. Slice with a wet, sharp knife into even pieces.
5. Serve with soy sauce and wasabi.

Pad Thai · Thailand

Sweet, savory, tangy | 30 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Rice noodles 250g
- Shrimp 300g
- Tamarind paste 2 tbsp
- Fish sauce 2 tbsp
- Bean sprouts 2 cups
- Roasted peanuts 1/3 cup
- Lime 1
- Garlic 3 cloves

Method

1. Soak the rice noodles until pliable.
2. Stir-fry the garlic and shrimp in a hot wok until just cooked.
3. Push aside, scramble an egg, then add the noodles and sauce mixture.
4. Toss everything together with bean sprouts until the noodles are coated.
5. Finish with peanuts, lime and extra bean sprouts.

Butter Chicken & Naan · India

Creamy, spiced, comforting | 50 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 800g
- Butter 60g
- Tomato puree 400g

- Heavy cream 1/2 cup
- Garam masala 2 tsp
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Naan

Method

1. Marinate the chicken in yogurt and spices, then grill or pan-sear until charred at the edges.
2. Cook garlic and ginger in butter, add tomato puree and simmer until deep red.
3. Blend the sauce smooth, then return to the pan with garam masala.
4. Add the chicken and cream, and simmer until the sauce coats the meat.
5. Serve with warm naan.

Bibimbap · South Korea

Colorful, balanced, savory | 45 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Short-grain rice 2 cups
- Thin-sliced beef 250g
- Spinach 1 bunch
- Carrots 2
- Zucchini 1
- Eggs 4
- Gochujang 3 tbsp
- Sesame oil
- Garlic 2 cloves

Method

1. Cook the rice and keep warm.
2. Blanch the spinach, and separately sauté the carrots and zucchini until just tender.
3. Marinate and sear the beef with garlic and sesame oil.
4. Fry an egg per bowl, sunny-side up.
5. Arrange rice topped with vegetables, beef and egg, with gochujang to mix in.

Beef Pho · Vietnam

Fragrant broth, herby, light | 2 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Beef bones 1.5kg
- Beef sirloin 300g
- Star anise 4
- Cinnamon stick 1
- Ginger 1 knob
- Rice noodles 300g
- Bean sprouts, herbs, lime

Method

1. Char the ginger and onion, then simmer with the bones and spices for at least two hours.
2. Strain the broth and season with fish sauce.
3. Cook the rice noodles and divide into bowls.

4. Top with thin-sliced raw beef, then ladle over the boiling broth to cook it.
5. Serve with bean sprouts, herbs and lime.

Beef Rendang · Indonesia

Slow-cooked, coconut, deeply spiced | 3 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Beef chuck 1kg
- Coconut milk 800ml
- Lemongrass 3 stalks
- Galangal 1 knob
- Shallots 8
- Chilies 6
- Kaffir lime leaves 5

Method

1. Blend the shallots, chilies, galangal and lemongrass into a paste.
2. Fry the paste until fragrant, then add the beef and coat well.
3. Pour in the coconut milk and kaffir lime leaves, and bring to a simmer.
4. Cook uncovered on low heat, stirring occasionally, until the sauce reduces and darkens.
5. Continue until the beef is deeply tender and coated in thick sauce.

Pork Dumplings · China

Juicy, folded, dipped in vinegar | 75 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Ground pork 400g
- Napa cabbage 1/2 head
- Dumpling wrappers 40
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Scallions 4
- Soy sauce, sesame oil, vinegar

Method

1. Salt the shredded cabbage, then squeeze out the liquid.
2. Mix the cabbage with pork, ginger, scallions, soy sauce and sesame oil.
3. Fill each wrapper, pleat and seal the edges.
4. Steam or pan-fry with a splash of water until cooked through.
5. Serve with a vinegar and soy dipping sauce.

Kung Pao Chicken · China

Spicy, nutty, stir-fried | 30 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 500g
- Roasted peanuts 1/2 cup
- Dried chilies 6
- Garlic 3 cloves
- Ginger 1 tbsp

- Soy sauce 3 tbsp
- Rice vinegar 2 tbsp
- Scallions 3

Method

1. Marinate the diced chicken briefly in a little soy sauce.
2. Stir-fry the dried chilies, garlic and ginger in a hot wok until fragrant.
3. Add the chicken and stir-fry until just cooked.
4. Stir in the sauce mixture and peanuts, tossing to coat.
5. Finish with scallions and serve immediately.

Shoyu Ramen · Japan

Savory broth, springy noodles | 45 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Ramen noodles 4 portions
- Chicken or pork stock 6 cups
- Soy sauce 4 tbsp
- Mirin 2 tbsp
- Soft-boiled eggs 4
- Scallions
- Nori sheets

Method

1. Simmer the stock with soy sauce and mirin until well seasoned.
2. Cook the noodles separately until just tender, then drain.
3. Divide the noodles among bowls and ladle over the hot broth.
4. Top each bowl with a halved soft-boiled egg and scallions.
5. Add a sheet of nori and serve immediately.

Chicken Adobo · Philippines

Tangy, savory, braised | 45 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 1kg
- Soy sauce 1/2 cup
- White vinegar 1/3 cup
- Garlic 6 cloves
- Bay leaves 2
- Black peppercorns 1 tsp

Method

1. Combine the chicken, soy sauce, vinegar, garlic, bay leaves and peppercorns in a pot.
2. Bring to a simmer uncovered, without stirring, for several minutes.
3. Cover and simmer until the chicken is tender.
4. Uncover and reduce the sauce until it thickens slightly.
5. Serve over rice with the sauce spooned over.

Chicken Karahi · Pakistan

Tomato-rich, gingery, bold | 40 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 1kg
- Tomatoes 4
- Ginger 2 tbsp
- Garlic 1 tbsp
- Green chilies 3
- Coriander seeds 1 tsp
- Yogurt 1/4 cup

Method

1. Fry the chicken in hot oil until browned on all sides.
2. Add ginger, garlic and coriander seeds, and cook until fragrant.
3. Stir in the chopped tomatoes and simmer until they break down into a thick sauce.
4. Add chilies and a spoon of yogurt, and simmer until the chicken is cooked through.
5. Finish with julienned ginger and fresh coriander.

Chicken Bhuna · Bangladesh

Thick, dark, deeply spiced | 50 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 1kg
- Onions 3
- Garlic 1 tbsp
- Ginger 1 tbsp
- Turmeric 1 tsp
- Chili powder 1 tsp
- Mustard oil 3 tbsp

Method

1. Fry the sliced onions in mustard oil until deep golden.
2. Add garlic, ginger and spices, and fry until fragrant.
3. Add the chicken and cook uncovered, stirring often, until the liquid evaporates and the sauce clings to the meat.
4. Continue frying until the oil separates at the edges.
5. Serve with rice or flatbread.

Sri Lankan Chicken Curry · Sri Lanka

Coconut, curry leaves, roasted spice | 45 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 1kg
- Coconut milk 1.5 cups
- Roasted curry powder 2 tbsp
- Curry leaves 1 sprig
- Onion 1
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Cinnamon stick 1

Method

1. Fry the onion, garlic, cinnamon and curry leaves until fragrant.

2. Add the chicken and curry powder, and cook until coated and lightly browned.
3. Pour in the coconut milk and simmer until the chicken is tender and the sauce thickens.
4. Adjust seasoning with salt.
5. Serve with rice.

European Recipes

Pasta Carbonara · Italy

Classic, creamy, rich | 25 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Spaghetti 400g
- Guanciale 150g
- Egg yolks 4
- Pecorino Romano 100g
- Black pepper

Method

1. Cook the spaghetti in well-salted water.
2. Render the guanciale in a pan until crisp.
3. Whisk the yolks with grated pecorino and plenty of black pepper.
4. Toss the hot, drained pasta with the guanciale off the heat, then quickly stir in the egg mixture, loosening with pasta water.
5. Serve immediately with extra pecorino.

Coq au Vin · France

Slow-braised, winey | 90 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 8
- Red wine 750ml
- Bacon lardons 150g
- Mushrooms 300g
- Pearl onions 200g
- Carrots 3
- Thyme

Method

1. Brown the chicken and set aside, then render the lardons in the same pot.
2. Sauté the carrots, pearl onions and mushrooms.
3. Return the chicken, add the wine and thyme, and bring to a simmer.
4. Cover and braise gently until the chicken is very tender.
5. Reduce the sauce if needed before serving.

Seafood Paella · Spain

Saffron rice, coastal, sociable | 55 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Bomba or paella rice 2 cups
- Shrimp 300g
- Mussels 300g
- Squid 200g
- Saffron pinch

- Bell pepper 1
- Tomatoes 2

Method

1. Sauté the pepper and tomatoes in a paella pan with olive oil.
2. Add the rice and saffron, and stir to coat.
3. Pour in hot stock, spread the rice evenly, and stop stirring.
4. Nestle in the seafood and simmer until the rice is cooked and a crust forms on the bottom.
5. Rest for five minutes before serving.

Pork Schnitzel · Germany

Crisp, golden, simple | 35 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Pork cutlets 4
- Flour 1 cup
- Eggs 2
- Breadcrumbs 1.5 cups
- Lemon 1
- Butter for frying

Method

1. Pound the cutlets thin between plastic wrap.
2. Dredge each in flour, then egg, then breadcrumbs.
3. Fry in butter until deep golden on both sides.
4. Drain briefly on paper towels.
5. Serve with a wedge of lemon.

Moussaka · Greece

Layered, baked, comforting | 90 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Eggplant 3
- Ground lamb 500g
- Tomatoes 400g
- Onion 1
- Béchamel sauce 2 cups
- Cinnamon 1/2 tsp

Method

1. Salt and roast or fry the eggplant slices until soft.
2. Brown the lamb with onion, tomatoes and cinnamon into a thick ragu.
3. Layer eggplant and ragu in a baking dish.
4. Top with béchamel sauce.
5. Bake until golden and set, then rest before slicing.

Fish and Chips · United Kingdom

Crisp batter, flaky fish | 45 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Cod fillets 4
- Flour 1.5 cups
- Cold sparkling water 1.5 cups
- Potatoes 4, cut into chips
- Oil for frying
- Malt vinegar

Method

1. Cut and fry the potatoes in two stages for crisp chips.
2. Whisk flour and cold sparkling water into a light batter.
3. Dip the fish in the batter and fry until golden and crisp.
4. Drain the fish and chips on a rack.
5. Serve with malt vinegar and salt.

Pierogi · Poland

Filled dumplings, buttery | 75 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Flour 3 cups
- Potatoes 4, boiled
- Farmer's cheese 1 cup
- Onion 1
- Butter
- Sour cream

Method

1. Make a simple dough from flour, water and a pinch of salt; rest it.
2. Mash the potatoes with cheese and most of a fried onion for the filling.
3. Roll the dough thin and cut rounds; fill and pinch each one closed.
4. Boil the pierogi until they float, then drain.
5. Pan-fry briefly in butter with the remaining onion, and serve with sour cream.

Beef Stroganoff · Russia

Creamy, tangy, comforting | 35 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Beef sirloin 600g, sliced thin
- Mushrooms 300g
- Onion 1
- Sour cream 1 cup
- Dijon mustard 1 tbsp
- Beef stock 1/2 cup

Method

1. Sear the beef strips quickly over high heat, then set aside.
2. Sauté the onion and mushrooms in the same pan until golden.
3. Add stock and mustard, and simmer briefly.
4. Stir in the sour cream off the heat, then return the beef.
5. Serve over egg noodles or rice.

American Recipes

New England Clam Chowder · United States

Creamy, briny, comforting | 45 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Clams 500g
- Potatoes 3
- Bacon lardons 100g
- Celery 2 stalks
- Onion 1
- Heavy cream 1 cup
- Thyme

Method

1. Render the bacon, then sauté the onion and celery in the fat.
2. Add potatoes and clam juice, and simmer until the potatoes are tender.
3. Add the clams and cream, and warm through gently.
4. Season and finish with thyme.
5. Serve hot with crackers or bread.

Poutine · Canada

Fries, cheese curds, gravy | 35 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Russet potatoes 5, cut into fries
- Cheese curds 2 cups
- Beef gravy 2 cups
- Oil for frying

Method

1. Fry the potatoes twice for a crisp exterior and fluffy center.
2. Warm the gravy until simmering.
3. Pile the fries on a plate and scatter with cheese curds.
4. Pour the hot gravy over immediately so the curds begin to soften.
5. Serve right away.

Latin American Recipes

Cheese Arepas · Colombia

Griddled corn cakes, cheesy | 30 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Pre-cooked cornmeal 2 cups
- Warm water 2.5 cups
- Salt 1 tsp
- Mozzarella or queso fresco 1 cup

Method

1. Mix the cornmeal, water and salt into a soft dough.
2. Knead in the cheese and rest the dough briefly.
3. Shape into rounds about 1cm thick.
4. Cook on a hot griddle until golden on both sides and cooked through.
5. Serve warm, split and filled if you like.

Tacos al Pastor · Mexico

Spicy, fresh, flavorful | 40 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Corn tortillas 12
- Pork shoulder 600g
- Dried guajillo chilies 3
- Pineapple 1 cup diced
- Lime 2
- Cilantro
- Onion 1

Method

1. Blend the soaked chilies with garlic and spices into a marinade.
2. Coat the pork and marinate for at least two hours.
3. Sear the pork in a hot pan until charred and cooked through, then chop finely.
4. Warm the tortillas and fill with pork and a spoon of pineapple.
5. Top with onion, cilantro and lime.

Feijoada · Brazil

Rich, smoky, slow-cooked | 3 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Black beans 500g
- Smoked sausage 300g
- Pork shoulder 500g
- Bay leaves 2
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Onion 1
- Oranges 2

- White rice

Method

1. Soak the black beans overnight.
2. Simmer the beans with the pork and sausage until tender, at least two hours.
3. Sauté onion and garlic, then stir into the pot with bay leaves.
4. Continue simmering until the sauce thickens.
5. Serve over rice with orange slices on the side.

Beef Empanadas · Argentina

Baked pastry, savory filling | 60 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Empanada dough discs 16
- Ground beef 500g
- Onion 1
- Hard-boiled eggs 2
- Cumin 1 tsp
- Green olives 1/2 cup

Method

1. Cook the beef and onion with cumin until browned and fragrant.
2. Cool the filling, then stir in chopped egg and olives.
3. Fill each dough disc, fold and crimp the edges.
4. Brush with egg wash.
5. Bake until golden and crisp.

Lomo Saltado · Peru

Stir-fried beef, fries, soy-sharp | 30 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Beef sirloin 500g, sliced
- French fries, cooked
- Red onion 1
- Tomatoes 2
- Soy sauce 3 tbsp
- Red wine vinegar 1 tbsp
- Cilantro

Method

1. Sear the beef in a very hot pan until browned, then set aside.
2. Stir-fry the onion and tomatoes briefly, keeping them a little crisp.
3. Return the beef, add soy sauce and vinegar, and toss over high heat.
4. Fold in the fries right at the end so they stay crisp.
5. Finish with cilantro and serve with rice.

Cazuela · Chile

Chicken and vegetable stew, homey | 70 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs 1kg
- Pumpkin 300g
- Potatoes 2
- Corn on the cob 2
- Rice 1/2 cup
- Onion 1
- Carrots 2

Method

1. Simmer the chicken with onion in water to cover until nearly tender.
2. Add the pumpkin, potatoes, carrots and corn, and continue simmering.
3. Stir in the rice and cook until everything is tender.
4. Season with salt and a little oregano.
5. Serve in deep bowls with the broth.

Jerk Chicken · Jamaica

Smoky, spicy, deeply marinated | 50 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken thighs and drumsticks 1.2kg
- Scotch bonnet peppers 2
- Scallions 4
- Allspice 2 tbsp
- Thyme
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Lime 1

Method

1. Blend the peppers, scallions, allspice, thyme, garlic and lime juice into a marinade.
2. Coat the chicken well and marinate at least a few hours, ideally overnight.
3. Grill over medium heat, turning often, until charred and cooked through.
4. Baste occasionally with leftover marinade early in cooking.
5. Rest briefly before serving.

Ropa Vieja · Cuba

Shredded beef, peppers, tomato | 2.5 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Flank steak 800g
- Bell peppers 2
- Onion 1
- Tomato sauce 1.5 cups
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Cumin 1 tsp
- Bay leaves 2

Method

1. Simmer the flank steak in water with bay leaves until very tender, then shred it, reserving the broth.
2. Sauté onion, peppers and garlic until soft.
3. Stir in tomato sauce, cumin and a splash of the reserved broth.

4. Add the shredded beef and simmer until the sauce thickens around it.
5. Serve with rice and black beans.

Middle Eastern Recipes

Turkish Kebab · Turkey

Grilled, herby, juicy | 40 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Ground lamb 500g
- Onion 1
- Flatbread
- Tomatoes 2
- Sumac 1 tsp
- Flat-leaf parsley
- Green peppers 2

Method

1. Grate the onion and squeeze out the excess liquid.
2. Mix with the lamb, sumac and seasoning, and knead until sticky.
3. Shape onto skewers.
4. Grill, turning occasionally, until charred outside and cooked through.
5. Serve on flatbread with grilled tomatoes and peppers.

Falafel · Lebanon

Crisp, herby, plant-based | 40 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Dried chickpeas 2 cups, soaked overnight
- Flat-leaf parsley 1 bunch
- Cilantro 1 bunch
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Cumin 2 tsp
- Tahini, pita, lime

Method

1. Drain the soaked chickpeas well, do not cook them.
2. Blend with herbs, garlic and spices to a coarse, sticky paste.
3. Rest the mixture briefly, then shape into balls or patties.
4. Fry until deep golden and crisp outside.
5. Serve in pita with tahini sauce.

Hummus with Warm Pita · Israel

Creamy, garlicky, simple | 20 min | Easy

Ingredients

- Cooked chickpeas 2 cups
- Tahini 1/3 cup
- Lemon 1
- Garlic 2 cloves
- Olive oil

- Cumin 1/2 tsp

Method

1. Blend the chickpeas with tahini, lemon juice and garlic.
2. Add ice water gradually while blending until light and fluffy.
3. Season with cumin and salt to taste.
4. Spread onto a plate and swirl with olive oil.
5. Serve with warm pita.

Saffron Rice with Lamb · Iran

Fragrant, jewelled, festive | 75 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Basmati rice 2 cups
- Lamb shoulder 600g
- Saffron pinch
- Barberries 1/2 cup
- Pistachios 1/3 cup
- Onion 1

Method

1. Braise the lamb with onion and spices until tender.
2. Parboil the rice, then layer with the lamb in a pot.
3. Steam gently until the rice is fully cooked and a crust forms at the base.
4. Toast the barberries and pistachios briefly in butter.
5. Serve the rice topped with the lamb and jewelled garnish.

Chicken Kabsa · Saudi Arabia

Spiced rice, whole chicken, festive | 80 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Basmati rice 2 cups
- Chicken quarters 1kg
- Tomatoes 2
- Onion 1
- Kabsa spice mix 2 tbsp
- Garlic 4 cloves
- Raisins and almonds for garnish

Method

1. Brown the chicken pieces, then set aside.
2. Fry the onion and garlic, add tomatoes and kabsa spices, and cook into a thick base.
3. Return the chicken, add water to cover and simmer until tender.
4. Remove the chicken, stir the rice into the remaining liquid and cook until done.
5. Serve the rice topped with the chicken and a scatter of raisins and almonds.

Chicken Mansaf · Jordan

Yogurt sauce, rice, festive | 70 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Chicken pieces 1kg
- Dried yogurt (jameed) or plain yogurt 3 cups
- Rice 2 cups
- Flatbread
- Almonds and pine nuts, toasted
- Cardamom pods

Method

1. Simmer the chicken in water with cardamom until tender; reserve the broth.
2. Whisk the yogurt with a little broth and warm gently, stirring constantly so it doesn't split.
3. Cook the rice in the remaining broth.
4. Spread flatbread on a platter, top with rice, then the chicken.
5. Pour the warm yogurt sauce over, and scatter with toasted nuts.

Dolma · Iraq

Stuffed vegetables, rice, tangy | 90 min | Medium

Ingredients

- Grape leaves or small vegetables (peppers, zucchini) 20
- Rice 1.5 cups
- Ground beef 300g
- Tomato 1
- Mint and parsley
- Lemon juice 1/4 cup

Method

1. Mix the rice with ground beef, chopped tomato and herbs for the filling.
2. Hollow the vegetables, or lay out grape leaves, and fill with the rice mixture.
3. Roll or close each one snugly and pack into a pot.
4. Add water and lemon juice to cover, weigh down with a plate, and simmer until the rice is cooked.
5. Serve warm or at room temperature.

Oceania Recipes

Pavlova · Australia

Crisp meringue, soft center | 2 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Egg whites 6
- Caster sugar 1.5 cups
- Cornstarch 1 tbsp
- White vinegar 1 tsp
- Whipped cream, berries

Method

1. Whisk the egg whites to soft peaks, then add sugar gradually until stiff and glossy.
2. Fold in cornstarch and vinegar.
3. Shape onto a lined tray and bake low and slow until crisp outside.
4. Cool completely in the oven with the door ajar.
5. Top with whipped cream and berries just before serving.

Hangi-Style Lamb & Kumara · New Zealand

Smoky, earthy, slow-cooked | 3 hr | Medium

Ingredients

- Lamb shoulder 1kg
- Kumara (sweet potato) 4
- Cabbage 1/2 head
- Carrots 3
- Chicken stock

Method

1. Season the lamb well and place in a heavy oven-proof pot.
2. Layer the kumara, carrots and cabbage around it.
3. Add a little stock, cover tightly to trap the steam.
4. Cook low and slow until the lamb is falling-apart tender.
5. Rest briefly, then serve everything together.

Kokoda · Fiji

Citrus-cured fish, coconut, fresh | 30 min | Easy

Ingredients

- White fish fillets 500g
- Lime juice 1 cup
- Coconut milk 1 cup
- Red onion 1
- Tomato 1
- Chili 1
- Cilantro

Method

1. Dice the fish and cover in lime juice; refrigerate until it turns opaque, about 20 minutes.
2. Drain most of the lime juice, keeping the fish.
3. Stir in coconut milk, diced onion, tomato and chili.
4. Season with salt and finish with cilantro.
5. Serve well chilled, in half a coconut shell if you have one.